

Multicultural Britain: A Melting Pot or a Salad Bowl?

Explore how cultures live together in the UK.

Food travels

01

Think

What is your favourite foreign food?

02

Compare

Is it exactly the same in its country of origin?

03

Notice

What happens when cultures meet?



WORDS

Key vocabulary

Match 1–4 with definitions A–D.

Term	Definition
1. melting pot	**A The process of becoming part of a new culture and losing your old cultural identity.**
2. salad bowl	**B A metaphor for a society where different cultures mix together and create one new, blended culture.**
3. assimilation	**C A metaphor for a society where different cultures live together but keep their own unique traditions and identities.**
4. diversity	**D The state of having a lot of variety (different people, cultures, ideas).**

TWO METAPHORS

Two ways to imagine society





Melting pot

Cultures blend into one new culture.

Salad bowl

Cultures live together but keep their own identity.

Question: Which metaphor sounds closer to modern Britain?

Read to find the answer

1. Skim the text for one minute.

2. **Question:** Which metaphor best describes the UK today?

3. Read carefully. Underline examples of the “salad bowl” idea.



Multicultural Britain today

People from all over the world have moved to the United Kingdom for centuries. Today, the UK is a diverse society.

The “melting pot” metaphor expects people to assimilate and create one unified culture, leaving old traditions behind.

The “salad bowl” metaphor suggests that people live together, contribute to society, and keep their languages, religions, and traditions.

Find evidence in the text

1. What did “melting pot” mean historically in the USA?

2. How is a “salad bowl” different?

3. Find two examples that show the UK is a “salad bowl” society.

4. Find the word meaning “to become part of a group or culture, often losing your original identity”.

EVERYDAY LIFE

The “salad bowl” in everyday life

Food

Chicken Tikka Masala is described as a British national dish.

Languages

Over 300 languages are spoken in London.

Music

Different cultural influences meet and shape popular music.

Does diversity make a society weaker or stronger? Why?





ROLE-PLAY

City Council Meeting

You have £10,000 to promote multiculturalism in a diverse British city.

In groups, choose only three projects to fund. Be ready to explain your choices.

- Welcome Centre: free English classes
- World Food Festival
- Cultural Heritage Museum
- Integration Sports Club
- Mother Tongue School

DECISION

Make your council decision

Our three projects:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

We chose them because they help people to…

communicate

meet each other

keep cultural identity

participate in society

DISCUSSION

Dialogue of cultures

1. Is your country more like a melting pot or a salad bowl? Give examples.
2. What are the main challenges of a multicultural society?
3. How can we avoid cultural conflicts?